28 Writing a Story

You have learnt how to jot down points, organize them properly and write an essay.

Now, let us see how a given outline can be developed into a story. You have to follow a few simple rules:

1. The outline of the story is usually given to you in the form of points. Read the outline carefully and try to understand what the story that you have been asked to write should be all about. Develop the points into full sentences. You may add some details of your own to make the story interesting.
2. You must make your story enjoyable for those who will read it. If the characters are animals, you have to make them talk and behave like human beings. The outlines in the *Exercise* below are taken from *Aesop's Fables* and the *Panchatantra*. To make your story come alive, introduce bits of conversation.
3. You have learnt about verbs and tenses. The outline may be given to you in the *present tense*. However, when you write your story, you must write it in the *past tense,* for you are narrating something that has already happened.
4. Give your story a *title*. The title should be related in some vital way to one or more of the important characters or events of the story, or to what the story wants to tell the readers. The title must be written in one of the ways shown on page 90 of this Book (Chapter 21) and do not put it within quotation marks. Try not to use any punctuation mark at all in the title. Look at the way the titles of the given stories have been written.

Given on the next page are two examples of how to develop an outline into a story. Read the outlines before you read the stories. The second story is in more detail. This is to help you understand how you can make a story more interesting by adding simple descriptions and conversation.

Example A: Wind says he is stronger than Sun—Sun disagrees—they see a man on the road—Wind says he can make man take off coat and Sun cannot—Sun accepts challenge—Wind blows very hard—man draws coat tighter—Sun shines fiercely—man feels hot—takes off coat—Wind admits Sun is stronger

The Wind and the Sun

One day, the Wind boasted that he was much stronger than the Sun. The Sun beamed and said that he was much stronger and he could prove it. The Wind was quite annoyed.

'There is a man walking down the road. Just watch me. I shall make him take off his coat,' said the Wind. He huffed and he puffed with all his might. The man only drew his coat tighter round himself to keep warm.

'Let me try,' said the Sun when the Wind was tired of blowing. He shone down fiercely on the man. His rays were hot and piercing. The man began to feel hot. He took off his coat and started wiping the sweat from his brow.

'I have won,' smiled the Sun.

'Yes, you have,' admitted the Wind.

Example B: Pair of crows live in banyan tree—a black snake comes to live at the bottom of the tree—eats up the baby crows—crows very unhappy—plan to leave their home—go to ask their friend, the Fox, for advice—Fox has a plan—tells them that the ladies of the palace will bathe in the river the next day—they will leave their jewels on the bank—crows should take the jewels, fly back to the banyan tree, and drop them in the snake's hole—crows do as told—servants follow with sticks—search the hole—snake comes out—servants kill it—take back jewels—crows very grateful to Fox for this idea

The Crows and the Black Snake

Mr and Mrs Crow lived happily in an old, banyan tree, with their family of little baby crows. But then, an evil black snake came to live in a hole at the bottom of the tree trunk.

One morning, Mr Crow and his wife flew out of their nest to bring food for their young ones. As soon as the snake saw them leave, he slithered up the trunk and ate all the little, fluffy nestlings. Mr and Mrs Crow were very sad and cried a lot but could not do anything as they were frightened of the snake.

'I am afraid we have to leave this tree,' said Mr Crow sadly.

'But we have lived here for such a long time. I love this place,' said his wife.

'Let's go to our friend Mr Fox and ask him what to do. He is a clever fellow and will certainly think of a way to help us,' said Mr Crow.

So they went to Mr Fox and told him the whole sad story. Mr Fox thought for a while and then said, 'Why should you leave your home? You have lived happily there for so long. Listen, tomorrow the ladies of the palace will come down to the river to have a bath. They will keep their clothes and jewels on the bank. You must pick up some of the jewels and fly away. The servants, guarding the jewels, will certainly see you and follow you to get the jewels back.'

'And then?' cried Mrs Crow.

'Then you must fly back to the banyan tree and drop the jewels into the black snake's hole.'

Mr and Mrs Crow did what Mr Fox told them. The palace servants followed them, shouting loudly. They then put their sticks into the hole to recover the jewels. The snake came hissing out, ready to attack. The servants surrounded the snake and beat it to death. Then they took the jewels out of the hole and went away.

Mr and Mrs Crow were delighted. They thanked Mr Fox over and over again for the wonderful plan that had helped them to get rid of the dreadful black snake.

Develop the following outlines into stories:

1. Farmer finds goose in forest—brings it home—it lays a golden egg every day—farmer sells eggs—becomes rich—farmer's wife greedy—suggests they cut up the goose—can take out all the gold in its stomach—cut up goose—find nothing—lose goose and good fortune
2. Mice call meeting—cat kills some mice every day—how to prevent it—little mouse suggests tying a bell round cat's neck—bell will warn them—can run and hide—all agree: good idea—wise, old mouse asks a question—who will tie the bell—easy to make suggestions, not easy to put them into practice
3. Near a lake live Bharunda birds—each has two mouths but one stomach—a bird roams around—one mouth finds some nectar—other mouth wants half—

first mouth refuses—second mouth drinks poison to punish first mouth—bird dies because it has only one stomach—other Bharundas realize that lack of unity kills

4. Chitragreeva, king of doves, flying with retinue—sees grains of rice on ground—leads his followers down to eat rice—trapped by hunter's net—king tells followers to unite—together they can lift net—they do so—fly away with net—hunter loses birds, rice and net—in unity there is strength
5. Animals of the forest must send one animal every day to King Lion for his meal—one day a rabbit is selected—rabbit goes late—lion is angry—rabbit says he was stopped on the way by another lion—King Lion wants to see the other lion—rabbit leads him to a well—shows him his own reflection—foolish lion thinks it is another lion who has come to challenge him—jumps into well to attack it—lion is drowned—animals are grateful to clever little rabbit—intelligence wins the day

6. Donkey has to wander about in search of food—meets his friend, the jackal—at night they find a field full of ripe cucumber—have a feast—go every night—one night donkey is very full and happy—wants to sing—jackal tells him not to—donkey says jackal is jealous of his voice—sings loudly and happily—farmer hears the noise—beats up donkey—throws him into ditch—donkey sadly tells jackal he should have listened to him—listen to the voice of reason
7. Tortoise in a large tank—has two friends—pair of geese—are happy together—there is drought in the land—no rain—rivers, tanks drying up—geese decide to fly to safer place—tortoise wants to go with them—geese say they can fly—tortoise thinks of a plan—find a strong stick—he will hold on to the middle of the stick—geese will fly with him—geese say that if the tortoise opens his mouth to speak he will fall and die—tortoise says he will not speak—geese fly up carrying tortoise—fly over countryside—fly over town—people of the town shout in wonder at the strange sight—foolish tortoise gets angry—shouts back at the people—falls to his death—one must know when to speak